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Adyen

Team Lead, Learning & Development

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Dear Adyen Hiring Team,

The learning systems I have built were not designed inside an L&D department. They came out of places where the actual business problems were happening: a supply chain innovation lab, a pandemic that made eight courses impossible to run, a university where nobody had done this before. That is probably a different background than most candidates for this role. I think it is a better one.

At Windesheim I founded the Spark! Living Lab from scratch. Not a revision of something that already existed. A full learning architecture built on one conviction: the design should come from the business problem, not from what is easy to deliver. The lab has been running for five years. I stepped out of the daily operations two years ago because it no longer needed me. Along the way it produced Value Chain Hackers, a European AI research initiative that is genuinely independent now, and a set of student startups including an agri-tech company in Slovakia with €2M in funding. A learning system that keeps generating outcomes three years after you left is, to my mind, what Adyen means by positioning L&D as a core business driver.

The clearest proof that I can hold a strategic ambition together under real pressure is the COVID mega project. Halfway through the semester, eight separate courses became impossible to run independently. In under two months I designed a new program structure, brought eight course leads with competing priorities into alignment, and rebuilt the assessment and delivery model around a shared sprint rhythm. It ran on time. Other departments used it as a template. What I took from that experience: a clear North Star makes fast decisions possible, because the prioritisation is already done.

On learning technology: I run an AI research environment at Windesheim on my own Linux servers. Flowise, OpenWebUI, n8n, Supabase. Not a demonstration setup. Researchers and students use it every week. I built it because I wanted to see where learners actually get stuck with AI tools, not where vendor demos say they do. There is a significant gap between those two things and I know it from watching it happen.

On team leadership: I have managed lab teams, coached startups to the point where they did not need me, and coordinated networks of external partners across organisations. My experience is distributed rather than concentrated in one org chart. I will say that plainly if it comes up. What I can show is a consistent pattern: the people I work with produce things that keep running after I leave.

Adyen to Baarn is about forty minutes. I have made that commute and it works fine.

Met vriendelijke groet,

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